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TRANSFORMER ASSEMBLIES AND TRANS-INDUCTANCE VOLTAGE REGULATION

Abstract

An assembly as discussed herein includes a layer of magnetically permeable material, a first transformer winding pair, a second transformer winding pair, and a first electrically conductive path. The first winding pair includes a first primary winding path and a first secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material. The second winding pair includes a second primary winding path and a second secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material. The assembly as discussed herein includes any number of additional transformer winding pairs, each of which includes a respective primary winding path and a secondary winding path. A series circuit path including the first electrically conductive path couples the first secondary winding path in series with the second secondary winding path and, if present, the additional secondary winding paths. Such a configuration supports a trans-inductance voltage regulator.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

[0001] A printed circuit board (PCB) or printed wiring board is a laminated structure of conductive layers separated by insulating layers. In general, PCBs have two functions. The first is to secure electronic components at designated locations on the outer layers of the PCB by means of affixing such as soldering. The electronic circuit instantiated by the populated circuit board is designed to provide one or more specific functions. After fabrication, the electronic circuit is powered to perform the desired functions.

[0002] Typically, a printed circuit board is a planar device on which multiple components are interconnected via traces to provide the functions as previously discussed. Such implementations of fabricating circuitry on a planar circuit board assembly is dimensionally limited, preventing high density implementation of circuitry.

[0003] It is further noted that a conventional TLVR (Trans-inductance Voltage Regulator) system is generally a voltage regulator (e.g. a buck converter) where the magnetic device is no longer a single-winding inductor, but a transformer with two windings; where the primary windings constitute the phase inductors. The secondary windings are the so called TLVR windings, which are used to improve the transient performance. The conventional TLVR voltage regulator receives an input voltage and produces an output voltage to power a load.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION

[0004] Implementation of clean energy (or green technology) is very important to reduce our impact as humans on the environment. In general, clean energy includes any evolving methods and materials to reduce an overall toxicity of energy consumption on the environment.

[0005] This disclosure includes the observation that raw energy, such as received from green energy sources or non-green energy sources, typically needs to be converted into an appropriate form (such as desired AC voltage, DC voltage, etc.) before it can be used to power end devices such as servers, computers, mobile communication devices, etc. Regardless of whether energy is received from green energy sources or non-green energy sources, it is desirable to make most efficient use of raw energy provided by such systems to reduce our impact on the environment. This disclosure contributes to reducing our carbon footprint (and green energy) via more efficient energy conversion and circuit implementations supporting same.

[0006] As discussed herein, a fabricator produces one or more assemblies to provide higher density circuitry than provided by conventional instantiation of voltage regulator circuitry on planar circuit boards.

[0007] More specifically, this disclosure includes an apparatus, systems, methods, etc. For example, an apparatus comprising: a layer of magnetically permeable material; a first winding pair including a first primary winding path and a first secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; a second winding pair including a second primary winding path and a second secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; and a first electrically conductive path coupling the first secondary winding path in series with the second secondary winding path.

[0008] In one example, a first portion of the first electrically conductive path extends through the layer of magnetically permeable material between a first node on a first surface of the layer and a second node on a second surface of the layer. A second portion of the first electrically conductive path extends adjacent to the first surface of the layer between the first secondary winding path and the first node; and a third portion of the first electrically conductive path extends adjacent to the

second surface of the layer between the second secondary winding path and the second node.

[0009] In accordance with still further examples, the first electrically conductive path as discussed herein does not pass through the layer of magnetically permeable material. In such an example, the first secondary winding path extends axially to a first node on a first surface of the layer; the second secondary winding path extends axially to a second node on a second surface of the layer; and the first electrically conductive path extends between the first node and the second node.

[0010] In accordance with another example as discussed herein, the apparatus further includes: a third winding pair including a third primary winding path and a third secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; a fourth winding pair including a fourth primary winding path and a fourth secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; and a second electrically conductive path coupling the third secondary winding path in series with the fourth secondary winding path. In such an example, a third electrically conductive path may couple the second secondary winding path in series with the third secondary winding path; and a fourth electrically conductive path may couple the fourth secondary winding path in series with the first secondary winding path.

[0011] The apparatus may further include a first node; a second node; and a series circuit path extending between the first node and the second node, the series circuit path connecting a combination of the first secondary winding, second secondary winding, third secondary winding, and the fourth secondary winding in series with each other. The series circuit path passes through the layer of magnetically permeable material multiple times.

[0012] In yet a further example, the apparatus includes a circuit component disposed between a first node and a second node; the first electrically conductive path may be a series circuit path extending between the first node and the second node. In the series circuit path may connect a combination of the first secondary winding and the second secondary winding in series. In one example, the circuit component is an inductor.

[0013] In accordance with another example as discussed herein, the apparatus may include: a third winding pair including a third primary winding path and a third secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; a fourth winding pair including a fourth primary winding path and a fourth secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; and a series circuit path including the first electrically conductive path, the series circuit path connecting the first secondary winding path, second secondary winding path, third secondary winding path and the fourth secondary winding path in series. If desired, the first primary winding path may be disposed diagonally across from the third primary winding path; the second primary winding path may be disposed diagonally across from the fourth primary winding path; the first secondary winding path and the third secondary winding path may be disposed between the first primary winding path and the third primary winding path; and the second secondary winding path and the fourth secondary winding path may be disposed between the second primary winding path and the fourth primary winding path.

[0014] Still further, note that a combination of the first primary winding path and the third primary winding path may be disposed between the first secondary winding path and the third secondary winding path; and a combination of the second primary winding path and the fourth primary winding path may be disposed between the second secondary winding path and the fourth secondary winding path.

[0015] Yet further, a portion of the series circuit path as discussed herein may reside outside of a volumetric portion of the magnetically permeable material disposed between a combination of the first primary winding path, second primary winding path, third primary winding path, and fourth primary winding path.

[0016] In yet another example, the layer of magnetically permeable material is a first substrate. The apparatus may further include: a second substrate, the first substrate affixed to the second substrate; and switch circuitry disposed on the second substrate, the switch circuitry operative to control first

current through the first primary winding path and second current through the second primary winding path. The apparatus may further include: a third substrate, the first substrate affixed to the third substrate; and a dynamic load powered by the first current and the second current, the third substrate disposed between the first substrate and the dynamic load.

[0017] As further discussed herein, the apparatus may include: a first substrate, wherein the layer of magnetically permeable material is embedded within the first substrate; and switch circuitry operative to control first current through the first primary winding path and second current through the second primary winding path. The apparatus may further include: a circuit component powered by the first current and the second current; and a second substrate, the first substrate affixed to the second substrate, the first substrate disposed between the second substrate and the circuit component.

[0018] Still further examples herein include a method comprising: receiving magnetically permeable material; fabricating a first winding pair to include a first primary winding path and a first secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; fabricating a second winding pair to include a second primary winding path and a second secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; and via a first electrically conductive path, coupling the first secondary winding path in series with the second secondary winding path.

[0019] Additionally, note that although each of the different features, techniques, configurations, etc., herein may be discussed in different places of this disclosure, it is intended, where suitable, that each of the concepts can optionally be executed independently of each other or in combination with each other. Accordingly, the one or more present inventions as described herein can be embodied and viewed in many different ways.

[0020] Also, note that this preliminary discussion of techniques herein (BRIEF DESCRIPTION) purposefully does not specify every novel aspect of the present disclosure or claimed invention(s). Instead, this brief description only presents general aspects and corresponding points of novelty over conventional techniques. For additional details and/or possible perspectives (permutations) of the invention(s), the reader is directed to the Detailed Description section (which is a summary) and corresponding figures of the present disclosure as further discussed below.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0021] FIG. 1 is an example 3-D (3-Dimensional) diagram illustrating a transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0022] FIG. 2 is an example 3-D diagram of a transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0023] FIG. 3 is an example 3-D diagram illustrating another implementation of a transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0024] FIG. 4 is an example top view diagram of the transformer assembly in FIG. 3 as discussed herein.

[0025] FIG. 5 is an example circuit diagram including implementation of any of the transformer assemblies as discussed herein.

[0026] FIG. 6 is an example 3-Dimensional (3-D) diagram illustrating an open circuit implementation of a transformer assembly (a.k.a., power converter assembly) as discussed herein.

[0027] FIG. 7 is an example 3-Dimensional (3-D) diagram illustrating an open circuit implementation of a transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0028] FIG. 8A is an example diagram illustrating a substrate and corresponding circuit components associated with a power converter assembly as discussed herein.

[0029] FIG. 8B is an example diagram illustrating a power converter circuit including a substrate and transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0030] FIG. **9** is an example 3-Dimensional diagram illustrating stacking of assemblies and/or circuit boards as discussed herein.

[0031] FIGS. **10A** and **10B** are example 3-Dimensional diagrams illustrating implementation of a transformer assembly between a host substrate and a respective load as discussed herein.

[0032] FIG. **11** is an example diagram illustrating implementation of a transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0033] FIG. **12** is an example method of fabricating a respective transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0034] The foregoing and other objects, features, and advantages of the disclosed matter herein will be apparent from the following more particular description herein, as illustrated in the accompanying drawings in which like reference characters refer to the same parts throughout the different views. The drawings are not necessarily to scale, with emphasis instead being placed upon illustrating the principles, concepts, aspects, techniques, etc.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0035] Now, more specifically, FIG. **1** is an example 3D diagram illustrating preliminary assembly of a transformer assembly (a.k.a., power converter assembly) as discussed herein.

[0036] In this example, a transformer assembly fabricator **150** or other suitable entity produces the assembly **101** to include any number of multiple transformer winding pairs. Each pair of primary winding and secondary winding represents a transformer disposed in the or through the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**.

[0037] For example, the fabricator **150** receives or produces a layer of magnetically permeable material **121**. The fabricator **150** produces the transformer assembly **101** to include a first transformer winding pair including a first primary winding path **PW1** and a first secondary winding path **SW1** to extend at least from the top surface **111** of the layer **121** through the layer **121** to at least the bottom surface **112** of the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**. Via the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**, the secondary winding **SW1** is magnetically or inductively coupled to the primary winding **PW1**.

[0038] The fabricator **150** produces the transformer assembly **101** to further include a second transformer winding pair including a second primary winding path **PW2** and a second secondary winding path **SW2** to extend at least from the top surface **111** of the layer **121** through the layer **121** to at least the bottom surface **112** of the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**. Via the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**, the secondary winding **SW2** is magnetically or inductively coupled to the primary winding **PW2**.

[0039] The fabricator **150** further produces the transformer assembly **101** to include a third transformer winding pair including a third primary winding path **PW3** and a third secondary winding path **SW3** to extend at least from the top surface **111** of the layer **121** through the layer **121** to at least the bottom surface **112** of the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**. Via the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**, the secondary winding **SW3** is magnetically or inductively coupled to the primary winding **PW3**.

[0040] The fabricator **150** produces the transformer assembly **101** to include a fourth transformer winding pair including a fourth primary winding path **PW4** and a fourth secondary winding path **SW4** to extend at least from the top surface **111** of the layer **121** through the layer **121** to at least the bottom surface **112** of the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**. Via the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**, the secondary winding **SW4** is magnetically or inductively coupled to the primary winding **PW4**.

[0041] In this manner, the fabricator **150** produces the transformer assembly **101** to include any number of transformer winding pairs.

[0042] Note that each of the primary winding paths (electrically conductive paths) and the secondary winding paths (electrically conductive paths) as discussed herein can be fabricated from metal such as copper or any suitable one or more electrically conductive materials.

[0043] Additionally, note that the fabrication of the assembly **101** can include drilling holes in the layer of magnetically permeable material **121** and subsequent insertion of the respective primary winding paths and the secondary winding paths in the drilled holes. Alternatively, fabrication of the assembly **101** can include injection of appropriate material in a respective mold to produce the layer of magnetically permeable material **121** such that each of the transformer windings extends between the top surface **111** and the bottom surface **112**.

[0044] In one example, each of the transformer windings (such as PW1, SW1, PW2, SW2, PW3, SW3, PW4, SW4, etc.) can extend axially along the y-axis. The top surface **111** of the assembly **101** resides parallel to the X-Z plane. The bottom surface **112** of the assembly **101** resides parallel to the X-Z plane as well. Accordingly, each of the transformer windings can be configured to extend orthogonally through the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**.

[0045] In accordance with further examples, note that each of the transformer windings can be fabricated in any suitable shape such as cylinder, etc. Further, note that each of the primary transformer windings may be of a first diameter while each of the secondary windings may be of a second diameter, wherein the first diameter is larger than the second diameter.

[0046] Additionally, as shown, the primary transformer winding PW1 extends between the node PN11 exposed on the top surface **111** and the node PN12 exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**; the primary transformer winding PW2 extends between the node PN21 exposed on the top surface **111** and the node PN22 exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**; the primary transformer winding PW3 extends between the node PN31 exposed on the top surface **111** and the node PN32 exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**; the primary transformer winding PW4 extends between the node PN41 exposed on the top surface **111** and the node PN42 exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**.

[0047] The secondary transformer winding SW1 extends between the node SN11 exposed on the top surface **111** and the node SN12 exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**; the secondary transformer winding SW2 extends between the node SN21 exposed on the top surface **111** and the node SN22 exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**; the secondary transformer winding SW3 extends between the node SN31 exposed on the top surface **111** and the node SN32 exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**; the secondary transformer winding SW4 extends between the node SN41 exposed on the top surface **111** and the node SN42 exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**.

[0048] Note further that the fabricator **150** can be configured to control a respective spacing between the primary winding and a secondary winding and a corresponding transformer winding pair. For example, for greater magnetic coupling between the primary winding and the secondary winding of a respective transformer winding pair, the fabricator **150** fabricates the primary winding and the secondary winding of the corresponding transformer winding pair to be closer to each other. If less coupling is desired, the fabricator **150** increases a respective distance between the primary winding and the secondary winding of the corresponding transformer winding pair.

[0049] FIG. 2 is an example 3-Dimensional (3-D) diagram illustrating a transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0050] In this example, the fabricator **150** provides serial connectivity of one or more of the secondary windings extending through the layer of magnetically permeable material **121**.

[0051] For example, the fabricator **150** can be configured to produce the transformer assembly **101** to include electrically conductive paths **21**, **22**, **23**, and **24** (such as fabricated from metal or other suitable one or more materials), each of which extend through the magnetically permeable material **121** at least from the surface **111** to the surface **112**.

[0052] More specifically, the electrically conductive path **21** extends between the node **211** exposed on the top surface **111** and the node **212** exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically

permeable material **121**; the electrically conductive path **22** extends between the node **221** exposed on the top surface **111** and the node **222** exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**; the electrically conductive path **23** extends between the node **231** exposed on the top surface **111** and the node **232** exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**; the electrically conductive path **24** extends between the node **241** exposed on the top surface **111** and the node **242** exposed on the bottom surface **112** of the magnetically permeable material **121**.

[0053] Each of the conductive paths **21**, **22**, **23**, and **24**, may extend axially along the y-axis orthogonal to or beyond each of the surface **111** and surface **112**.

[0054] Yet further, as shown in FIG. 2, the electrically conductive path **21** can be disposed in parallel and between the secondary transformer winding SW1 and the secondary transformer winding SW2; the electrically conductive path **22** can be disposed in parallel and between the secondary transformer winding SW2 and the secondary transformer winding SW3; the electrically conductive path **23** can be disposed in parallel and between the secondary transformer winding SW3 and the secondary transformer winding SW4; the electrically conductive path **24** can be disposed in parallel and between the secondary transformer winding SW4 and the secondary transformer winding SW1; and so on.

[0055] As further discussed herein, the fabricator **150** can be configured to produce the assembly **101** to include electrically conductive paths **215**, **216**, **225**, **226**, **235**, **236**, **245**, and **246**.

[0056] In one example, as further discussed below, the electrically conductive paths connect the secondary transformer windings in series.

[0057] More specifically, the electrically conductive path **215** is disposed adjacent to or along the surface **112** and provides connectivity between the node SN12 and the node **212**; the electrically conductive path **216** is disposed adjacent to or along the surface **111** and provides connectivity between the node **211** and the node SN21.

[0058] The electrically conductive path **225** is disposed adjacent to or along the surface **112** and provides connectivity between the node SN22 and the node **222**; the electrically conductive path **226** is disposed adjacent to or along the surface **111** and provides connectivity between the node **221** and the node SN31.

[0059] The electrically conductive path **235** is disposed adjacent to or along the surface **112** and provides connectivity between the node SN32 and the node **232**; the electrically conductive path **236** is disposed adjacent to or along the surface **111** and provides connectivity between the node **231** and the node SN41.

[0060] The electrically conductive path **245** is disposed adjacent to or along the surface **112** and provides connectivity between the node SN42 and the node **242**; the electrically conductive path **246** is disposed adjacent to or along the surface **111** and provides connectivity between the node **241** and the node SN11.

[0061] In accordance with a further example, each of the electrically conductive paths **215**, **216**, **225**, **226**, **235**, **236**, **245**, **246** are disposed orthogonal to the secondary transformer windings in the assembly **101**. The axial length of each of the electrically conductive path **215**, electrically conductive path **216**, electrically conductive path **235**, and electrically conductive path **236** can be disposed parallel to the X axis. The axial length of each of the electrically conductive path **225**, electrically conductive path **226**, electrically conductive path **245**, and electrically conductive path **246** can be disposed parallel to the Z axis.

[0062] Accordingly, the fabricator **150** can be configured to produce a series circuit path including sequential connectivity of one or more of the secondary transformer winding SW1, electrically conductive path **215**, electrically conductive path **21**, electrically conductive path **216**, secondary transformer winding SW2, electrically conductive path **225**, electrically conductive path **22**, electrically conductive path **226**, secondary transformer winding SW3, electrically conductive path **235**, electrically conductive path **23**, electrically conductive path **236**, secondary transformer

winding is SW4, electrically conductive path 245, electrically conductive path 24, electrically conductive path 246. Note that the flow of first currents each of the secondary windings (such as in one direction along the y-axis) is opposite the flow of second currents through each of the electrically conductive paths 21, 22, 23, and 24 (such as in a second direction along the Y-axis).

[0063] If desired, as further shown in FIG. 6, the electrically conductive path 225 can be removed so that a respective component 521 or multiple components such as one or more of an inductor, switch, etc., can be connected between the node 222 and the node SN22.

[0064] Thus, fabrication of the assembly 101 as discussed herein results in a respective electrically conductive path extending from the first node SN12 (on surface 112) of a secondary winding SW1 to a second node SN21 (on surface 111) of a second secondary winding SW2. A first portion (such as electrically conductive path 21) of the first electrically conductive path extends through the layer of magnetically permeable material 121 between a first node 211 on a first surface 111 of the layer and a second node 212 on a second surface 112 of the layer.

[0065] A second portion (215) of the first electrically conductive path extends adjacent to the surface 112 of the layer between the first secondary winding path SW1 and the node 212; a third portion (216) of the first electrically conductive path extends adjacent to the surface 111 of the layer between the second secondary winding path SW2 and the second node 211.

[0066] FIG. 3 is an example top view diagram of a transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0067] In this example, the fabricator 150 provides serial connectivity of one or more of the secondary windings extending through the layer of magnetically permeable material 121. However, the electrically conductive paths 21, 22, 23, and 24 can be disposed outside of the layer of electrically conductive material 121.

[0068] For example, the fabricator 150 can be configured to produce the transformer assembly 101-2 to include electrically conductive paths 21, 22, 23, and 24 (such as fabricated from metal or other suitable material), each of which does not extend through the magnetically permeable material 121 at least from the surface 111 to the surface 112.

[0069] More specifically, in this example, the electrically conductive path 21 resides external to the layer of magnetically permeable material 121 and extends between the node 211 and the node 212; the electrically conductive path 22 resides external to the layer of magnetically permeable material 121 and extends between the node 221 and the node 222; the electrically conductive path 23 resides external to the layer of magnetically permeable material 121 and extends between the node 231 and the node 232; the electrically conductive path 24 resides external to the layer of magnetically permeable material 121 extends between the node 241 and the node 242.

[0070] Each of the conductive paths 21, 22, 23, and 24, may extend axially along the y-axis.

[0071] As further discussed herein, the fabricator 150 can be configured to produce the assembly 101 to include pairs of electrically conductive paths 315, 316, 325, 326, 335, 336, 345, and 346.

[0072] In one example, one or more of the electrically conductive paths 315, 316, 325, 326, 335, 336, 345, and 346 connect the secondary transformer windings in series.

[0073] More specifically, the electrically conductive path 315 disposed adjacent to or along the surface 112 provides connectivity between the node SN12 and the node 212; the electrically conductive path 316 disposed adjacent to or along the surface 111 provides connectivity between the node 211 and the node SN21.

[0074] The electrically conductive path 325 disposed adjacent to or along the surface 112 provides connectivity between the node SN22 and the node 222; the electrically conductive path 326 disposed adjacent to or along the surface 111 provides connectivity between the node 221 and the node SN31.

[0075] The electrically conductive path 335 disposed adjacent to or along the surface 112 provides connectivity between the node SN32 and the node 232; the electrically conductive path 336 disposed adjacent to or along the surface 111 provides connectivity between the node 231 and the node SN41.

[0076] The electrically conductive path **345** disposed adjacent to or along the surface **112** provides connectivity between the node **SN42** and the node **242**; the electrically conductive path **346** disposed adjacent to or along the surface **111** provides connectivity between the node **241** and the node **SN11**.

[0077] In accordance with a further example, each of the electrically conductive paths **315**, **316**, **325**, **326**, **335**, **336**, **345**, and **346** are disposed orthogonal (such as in one or more planes parallel to the X-Z plane) to the primary transformer windings and the secondary transformer windings in the assembly **101**.

[0078] Accordingly, the fabricator **150** can be configured to produce a series circuit path including sequential connectivity of the secondary transformer winding **SW1**, electrically conductive path **315**, electrically conductive path **21**, electrically conductive path **316**, secondary transformer winding **SW2**, electrically conductive path **325**, electrically conductive path **22**, electrically conductive path **326**, secondary transformer winding **SW3**, electrically conductive path **335**, electrically conductive path **23**, electrically conductive path **336**, secondary transformer winding **SW4**, electrically conductive path **345**, electrically conductive path **24**, electrically conductive path **346**.

[0079] If desired, as further shown in FIG. 7, the electrically conductive path **325** or any one or more other electrically conductive paths can be removed so that a respective component **521** or multiple components such as one or more of an inductor, switch, etc., can be connected between the node **222** and the node **SN22** in series with the respective secondary windings.

[0080] Thus, fabrication of the assembly **101** as discussed herein results in a respective electrically conductive path extending from the first node **SN12** (on surface **112**) of a secondary winding **SW1** to a second node **SN21** (on surface **111**) of a second secondary winding **SW2**. A first portion (such as electrically conductive path **21**) of the first electrically conductive path extends outside of the layer of magnetically permeable material **121** between a first node **211** and a node **212**. A second portion (**315**) of the first electrically conductive path extends adjacent to the surface **112** of the layer between the first secondary winding path **SW1** and the node **212**; a third portion (**316**) of the first electrically conductive path extends adjacent to the surface **111** of the layer between the node **SN21** of the second secondary winding path **SW2** and the second node **211**.

[0081] In a similar manner, multiple segments such as electrically conductive path **325**, electrically conductive path **22**, and electrically conductive path **326** provide a series path between the node **SN22** and the node **SN31**; multiple segments such as electrically conductive path **335**, electrically conductive path **23**, and electrically conductive path **336** provide a series path between the node **SN32** and the node **SN41**; multiple segments such as electrically conductive path **345**, electrically conductive path **24**, and electrically conductive path **346** provide a series circuit path between the node **SN42** and the node **SN11**.

[0082] FIG. 4 is an example top view diagram of a respective transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0083] As previously discussed, multiple segments such as electrically conductive path **315**, electrically conductive path **21**, and electrically conductive path **316** provide a series path between the node **SN12** and the node **SN21**; multiple segments such as electrically conductive path **325**, electrically conductive path **22**, and electrically conductive path **326** provide a series path between the node **SN22** and the node **SN31**; multiple segments such as electrically conductive path **335**, electrically conductive path **23**, and electrically conductive path **336** provide a series path between the node **SN32** and the node **SN41**; multiple segments such as electrically conductive path **345**, electrically conductive path **24**, and electrically conductive path **346** provide a series circuit path between the node **SN42** and the node **SN11**.

[0084] FIG. 5 is an example circuit diagram including implementation of the transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0085] In this example, the power supply circuit **500** implements multiple switches and any of the

transformer assemblies as discussed herein to convert the input voltage V_{in} into the respective output voltage V_{out} . The power supply circuit **500** includes power converter phase **501**, power converter phase **502**, power converter phase **503**, and power converter phase **504** that operate in parallel to convert the input voltage V_{in} into the output voltage V_{out} .

[0086] Note that the power supply circuit **500** as discussed herein and corresponding transformer assembly **101** can include any number of transformer winding pairs.

[0087] More specifically, in this example of implementing for power converter phases operating in parallel to convert the input voltage into the output voltage, the controller **140** can be configured to monitor a magnitude of the output voltage V_{out} and generate respective control signals **105** to control the corresponding switches in each of the power converter phases to regulate the magnitude of the output voltage V_{out} at a desired level.

[0088] The first power converter phase **501** includes high side switch circuitry **511**, low side switch circuitry **512**, and corresponding transformer T1 (including primary winding PW1 and secondary winding SW1 associated with the assembly **101**).

[0089] The second power converter phase **502** includes high side switch circuitry **521**, low side switch circuitry **522**, and corresponding transformer T2 (including primary winding PW2 and secondary winding SW2 associated with the assembly **101**).

[0090] The third power converter phase **503** includes high side switch circuitry **531**, low side switch circuitry **532**, and corresponding transformer T3 (including primary winding PW3 and secondary winding SW3 associated with the assembly **101**).

[0091] The fourth power converter phase **504** includes high side switch circuitry **541**, low side switch circuitry **542**, and corresponding transformer T4 (including primary winding PW4 and secondary winding SW4 associated with the assembly **101**).

[0092] As further shown, via control of the respective high side switch circuitry **511** and low side switch circuitry **512** (such as associated with a buck converter configuration), the controller **140** controls conveyance of current from the switches (high side switch circuitry **511** and low side switch circuitry **512**) connected to node PN12 to produce the current M1 through the primary winding PW1 to the node PN11 and the output node N5 outputting the respective output voltage V_{out} .

[0093] Via control of the respective high side switch circuitry **521** and low side switch circuitry **522** (such as associated with a buck converter configuration), the controller **140** controls conveyance of current from the switches (high side switch circuitry **521** and low side switch circuitry **522**) connected to node PN22 to produce the current M2 through the primary winding PW2 to the node PN21 and the output node N5 outputting the respective output voltage V_{out} .

[0094] Via control of the respective high side switch circuitry **531** and low side switch circuitry **532** (such as associated with a buck converter configuration), the controller **140** controls conveyance of current from the switches (high side switch circuitry **531** and low side switch circuitry **532**) connected to node PN32 to produce the current M3 through the primary winding PW3 to the node PN31 and the output node N5 outputting the respective output voltage V_{out} .

[0095] Via control of the respective high side switch circuitry **541** and low side switch circuitry **542** (such as associated with a buck converter configuration), the controller **140** controls conveyance of current from the switches (high side switch circuitry **541** and low side switch circuitry **542**) connected to node PN42 to produce the current M4 through the primary winding PW4 to the node PN41 and the output node N5 outputting the respective output voltage V_{out} .

[0096] As previously discussed, the series circuit path connecting the secondary transformer windings can be configured to include a respective one or more component **521** or one or more component **522** at any point in the circuit path. In this example, the one or more circuit component **521** is disposed between the node SN21 and the node SN32, although this can vary depending on the example circuit.

[0097] FIG. 6 is an example 3-Dimensional (3-D) diagram illustrating an open circuit

implementation of a transformer assembly (a.k.a., power converter assembly) as discussed herein. [0098] As previously discussed, and as further shown in FIG. 6, the assembly **101** can be configured to include a first transformer winding pair **T1** including a first primary winding **PW1** and a first secondary winding **SW1** extending through the magnetically permeable material **121**. The assembly **101** includes a second transformer winding pair including a second primary winding **PW2** and a second secondary winding **SW2** extending through the magnetically permeable material **121**. The assembly **101** includes a third transformer winding pair including a third primary winding **PW3** and a third secondary winding **SW3** extending through the magnetically permeable material **121**. The assembly **101** includes a fourth transformer winding pair including a fourth primary winding **PW4** and a fourth secondary winding **SW4** extending through the magnetically permeable material **121**.

[0099] In one example, the first primary winding path **PW1** is disposed diagonally across from the third primary winding path **PW3**; second primary winding path **PW2** is disposed diagonally across from the fourth primary winding path **PW4**. The first secondary winding path **SW1** and the third secondary winding path **SW3** are disposed between the first primary winding path **PW1** and the third primary winding path **PW3**. The second secondary winding path **SW2** and the fourth secondary winding path **SW4** are disposed between the second primary winding path **PW2** and the fourth primary winding path **PW4**.

[0100] As previously discussed, the electrically conductive path **225** may be absent from the assembly **101**. If desired, the fabricator **150** or other suitable entity can be configured to connect a respective circuit component **521** between the node **222** and the node **SN22**. In such an instance, the circuit component **521** is connected in series with the secondary transformer windings of the assembly **101**.

[0101] Accordingly, examples herein include the assembly **101** including a first node (**222**), a second node (**SN22**), and a series circuit path extending between the first node and the second node. As previously discussed, the series circuit path (including the electrically conductive paths **21**, **22**, **23**, and **24**) connect a combination of the one or more component **521**, first secondary winding **SW1**, second secondary winding **SW2**, third secondary winding **SW3**, and the fourth secondary winding **SW4** in series with each other. See also FIG. 5.

[0102] Via the secondary windings **SW1**, **SW2**, **SW3**, **SW4**, electrically conductive path **21**, electrically conductive path **22**, electrically conductive path **23**, and electrically conductive path **24**, the series circuit path including the secondary windings passes through the layer of magnetically permeable material **111** multiple times.

[0103] FIG. 7 is an example 3-Dimensional (3-D) diagram illustrating an open circuit implementation of a transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0104] In this example, the fabricator **150** fabricates the assembly **101-2** such that a combination of the first primary winding path **PW1** and the third primary winding path **PW3** are disposed between the first secondary winding path **SW1** and the third secondary winding path **SW3**; the fabricator **150** fabricates the assembly **101-2** such that a combination of the second primary winding path **PW2** and the fourth primary winding path **PW4** are disposed between the second secondary winding path **SW2** and the fourth secondary winding path **SW4**.

[0105] Accordingly, as shown in FIG. 7, the series circuit path (such as including one or more of the secondary transformer winding **SW1**, electrically conductive path **315**, electrically conductive path **21**, electrically conductive path **316**, secondary transformer winding **SW2**, electrically conductive path **325**, electrically conductive path **22**, electrically conductive path **326**, secondary transformer winding **SW3**, electrically conductive path **335**, electrically conductive path **23**, electrically conductive path **336**, secondary transformer winding **SW4**, electrically conductive path **345**, electrically conductive path **24**, electrically conductive path **346**) resides outside of a volumetric portion of the magnetically permeable material **121** disposed between a combination of the first primary winding path **PW1**, second primary winding path **PW2**, third primary winding

path PW3, and fourth primary winding path PW4.

[0106] As previously discussed, the electrically conductive path **225** may be absent from the assembly **101**. If desired, the fabricator **150** or other suitable entity can be configured to connect a respective circuit component **521** between the node **222** and the node SN22. In such an instance, the circuit component **521** is connected in series with the secondary transformer windings of the assembly **101**.

[0107] FIG. **8A** is an example diagram illustrating a substrate and corresponding circuit components associated with a power converter as discussed herein.

[0108] FIG. **8B** is an example diagram illustrating a power converter circuit including a substrate and transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0109] In this example, the fabricator **150** receives or fabricates the corresponding assembly **801**. The assembly **801** includes substrate **810** as well as other components associated with the power converter circuit (power supply circuitry **500**) as previously discussed with respect to FIG. **5**. Note that any of the components associated with the power supply circuitry **500** such as capacitor C_{in} , controller **140**, high side switch circuitry **511**, low side switch circuitry **512**, high side switch circuitry **521**, low side switch circuitry **522**, high side switch circuitry **531**, low side switch circuitry **532**, high side switch circuitry **541**, low side switch circuitry **542**, capacitor C_{out} , etc., can be disposed on a surface **811** or surface **812** of the substrate **810**. The substrate **810** and corresponding assembly **101** support the connectivity of the components shown in the power supply circuitry **500**.

[0110] As further shown, the circuit board assembly **801** includes multiple surface pads **821**, **822**, **823**, and **824**. Surface pad **821** is the same as node N1 of the power supply circuitry **500**; surface pad **822** is the same as node N2 of the power supply circuitry **500**; surface pad **823** is the same as node N3 of the power supply circuitry **500**; surface pad **824** is the same as the node N4 of the power supply circuitry **500**.

[0111] Assembly **801** can be configured to further include controller **140** as well as any of the switch circuitry such as high side switch circuitry **511**, low side switch circuitry **512**, high side switch circuitry **521**, low side switch circuitry **522**, high side switch circuitry **531**, low side switch circuitry **532**, high side switch circuitry **541**, low side switch circuitry **542**. As previously discussed, the controller **140** controls operation of the respective switches to control a respective current supplied by each of the surface pads **821**, **822**, **823**, and **824** through a corresponding primary winding.

[0112] FIG. **8B** illustrates fabrication of the assembly **805** using the assembly **801** as well as the assembly discussed herein. In one example, coupling of the assembly **101** to the assembly **801** to produce the assembly **805** includes: connecting the node PN12 directly to the surface pad **821** (node N1); connecting the node PN22 directly to the surface pad **822** (node N2); connecting the node PN32 directly to the surface pad **823** (node N3); connecting the node PN42 directly to the surface pad **824** (node N4).

[0113] As further shown, the top surface **111** of the assembly **101** exposes the nodes PN11, PN21, PN31, and PN41. In one example, all of these nodes are connected together to the node N5 to produce the respective output voltage V_{out} as logically shown in FIG. **5**.

[0114] Accordingly, the apparatus such as the assembly **805** as discussed herein can be configured to include substrate **810** as well as assembly **101** (such as a substrate or other suitable entity), where the assembly **101** (such as a substrate) is affixed to the substrate **810**. Further, as previously discussed, switch circuitry such as associated with the power supply circuit **500** may be disposed on the substrate **810**. The switch circuitry (such as pairs of high side switch circuitry and low side switch circuitry) on the substrate **810** or other suitable entity: controls first current $M1$ from node N1 through the primary winding PW1 to the node N5; controls second current $M2$ from node N2 through the primary winding PW2 to the node N5; controls current $M3$ from node N3 through the primary winding PW3 to the node N5; controls current $M4$ from node N4 through the primary

winding PW4 to the node N5.

[0115] If desired, the assembly **805** can be configured to include additional electrically conductive paths **825-1**, **825-2**, and **825-3**, etc., disposed on an edge of the assembly **101**. As shown in FIG. **9**, the electrically conductive paths **825-1**, **825-2**, **825-3**, etc., (collectively electrically conductive path **825**) convey any suitable signals between the substrate **810** and corresponding load **118** (such as one or more circuit component, a computer processor, circuitry, etc.) affixed to a top of the surface **111**.

[0116] FIG. **9** is an example 3-Dimensional diagram illustrating stacking of assemblies as discussed herein.

[0117] In this example, the fabricator **150** or other suitable entity produces the respective circuit assembly **905** to include the assembly **805** as well as substrate **903** and corresponding power load **118**. Fabrication can include the fabricator **150** coupling the assembly **805** and corresponding exposed nodes (such as PN**11**, PN**12**, PN**13**, and PN**14**) to the pads disposed on surface **912** of the substrate **903** (such as a mother board or other suitable entity). The substrate **903** includes one or more electrically conductive paths extending from the or more pads disposed on the bottom surface **912** to the top surface **911** of the substrate **903**. Via the one or more electrically conductive path extending through the substrate **903**, the substrate **903** conveys output current (M**1**, M**2**, M**3**, M**4**) and corresponding output voltage Vout from the primary windings PW**1**, PW**2**, PW**3**, and PW**4** to the dynamic load **118**.

[0118] Accordingly, the apparatus such as the **905** can be configured to include the substrate **903** sandwiched between the assembly **805** and the dynamic load **118**. In other words, the substrate **903** is disposed between the dynamic load **118** and the assembly **805**. The surface **111** of the assembly **805** is directly coupled to the surface **912** of the substrate **903**. The substrate **903** and corresponding electrically conductive paths through the substrate **903** convey the respective output current M**1**, M**2**, M**3**, M**4**, as well as the output voltage Vout from the assembly **101** to the load **118**.

[0119] FIG. **10A** is an example 3-Dimensional diagram illustrating implementation of a transformer assembly between a host substrate and a respective load as discussed herein.

[0120] In this example, the fabricator **150** embeds the assembly **101** and/or switch circuitry in the substrate **1050**. As previously discussed, the switch circuitry may control delivery of respective current (M**1**, M**2**, M**3**, M**4**) and include high side switch circuitry **511**, low side switch circuitry **512**, high side switch circuitry **521**, low side switch circuitry **522**, high side switch circuitry **531**, low side switch circuitry **532**, high side switch circuitry **541**, low side switch circuitry **542**.

[0121] As shown in FIG. **10B**, a circuit component such as the load **118** is powered by the current M**1**, M**2**, M**3**, M**4** supplied by the assembly **101**. The load **118** is affixed to the top surface of the substrate **1050**. The bottom surface of the substrate **1050** is coupled to the top surface **911** of the substrate **903**. Accordingly, the substrate **1050** (assembly including the embedded assembly **101**) can be disposed between the load **118** and the substrate **911**.

[0122] FIG. **11** is an example diagram illustrating implementation of a transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0123] As previously discussed, the assembly **101** can be configured to include any number of transformer winding pairs. In this example, the example assembly **101-11** includes 6 transformer winding pairs. As previously discussed, and as further shown in FIG. **11**, the secondary windings can be connected in series via supplemental electrically conductive paths.

[0124] FIG. **12** is an example method of fabricating a respective transformer assembly as discussed herein.

[0125] In processing operation **1210**, the fabricator **150** receives magnetically permeable material.

[0126] In processing operation **1220**, the fabricator **150** fabricates a first winding pair of the transformer assembly to include a first primary winding path and a first secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material.

[0127] In processing operation **1230**, the fabricator **150** fabricates a second winding pair to include

a second primary winding path and a second secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material.

[0128] In processing operation **1240**, via a first electrically conductive path, the fabricator **150** couples the first secondary winding path in series with the second secondary winding.

[0129] Note again that techniques herein are well suited for use in circuit assembly applications such as those providing power delivery to one or more loads. However, it should be noted that the disclosure of matter herein is not limited to use in such applications and that the techniques discussed herein are well suited for other applications as well.

[0130] While this invention has been particularly shown and described with references to preferred aspects thereof, it will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes in form and details may be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present application as defined by the appended claims. Such variations are intended to be covered by the scope of this present application. As such, the foregoing description in the present disclosure is not intended to be limiting. Rather, any limitations to the invention are presented in the following claims.

Claims

1. An apparatus comprising: a layer of magnetically permeable material; a first winding pair including a first primary winding path and a first secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; a second winding pair including a second primary winding path and a second secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; and a first electrically conductive path coupling the first secondary winding path in series with the second secondary winding path.
2. The apparatus as in claim 1, wherein a first portion of the first electrically conductive path extends through the layer of magnetically permeable material between a first node on a first surface of the layer and a second node on a second surface of the layer.
3. The apparatus as in claim 2, wherein a second portion of the first electrically conductive path extends adjacent to the first surface of the layer between the first secondary winding path and the first node; and wherein a third portion of the first electrically conductive path extends adjacent to the second surface of the layer between the second secondary winding path and the second node.
4. The apparatus as in claim 1, wherein the first electrically conductive path does not pass through the layer of magnetically permeable material.
5. The apparatus as in claim 4, wherein the first secondary winding path extends axially to a first node on a first surface of the layer; wherein the second secondary winding path extends axially to a second node on a second surface of the layer; and wherein the first electrically conductive path extends between the first node and the second node.
6. The apparatus as in claim 1 further comprising: a third winding pair including a third primary winding path and a third secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; a fourth winding pair including a fourth primary winding path and a fourth secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; and a second electrically conductive path coupling the third secondary winding path in series with the fourth secondary winding path.
7. The apparatus as in claim 6 further comprising: a third electrically conductive path coupling the second secondary winding path in series with the third secondary winding path; and a fourth electrically conductive path coupling the fourth secondary winding path in series with the first secondary winding path.
8. The apparatus as in claim 6, further comprising: a first node; a second node; and a series circuit path extending between the first node and the second node, the series circuit path connecting a combination of the first secondary winding, second secondary winding, third secondary winding, and the fourth secondary winding in series with each other.

9. The apparatus as in claim 8, wherein the series circuit path passes through the layer of magnetically permeable material multiple times.

10. The apparatus as in claim 1 further comprising: a circuit component disposed between a first node and a second node; and wherein the first electrically conductive path is a series circuit path extending between the first node and the second node, the series circuit path connecting a combination of the first secondary winding and the second secondary winding in series.

11. The apparatus as in claim 1, wherein the circuit component is an inductor.

12. The apparatus as in claim 1 further comprising: a third winding pair including a third primary winding path and a third secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; a fourth winding pair including a fourth primary winding path and a fourth secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; and a series circuit path including the first electrically conductive path, the series circuit path connecting the first secondary winding path, second secondary winding path, third secondary winding path and the fourth secondary winding path in series.

13. The apparatus as in claim 12, wherein the first primary winding path is disposed diagonally across from the third primary winding path; wherein the second primary winding path is disposed diagonally across from the fourth primary winding path; wherein the first secondary winding path and the third secondary winding path are disposed between the first primary winding path and the third primary winding path; and wherein the second secondary winding path and the fourth secondary winding path are disposed between the second primary winding path and the fourth primary winding path.

14. The apparatus as in claim 12, wherein a combination of the first primary winding path and the third primary winding path are disposed between the first secondary winding path and the third secondary winding path; and wherein a combination of the second primary winding path and the fourth primary winding path are disposed between the second secondary winding path and the fourth secondary winding path.

15. The apparatus as in claim 12, wherein the series circuit path resides outside of a volumetric portion of the magnetically permeable material disposed between a combination of the first primary winding path, second primary winding path, third primary winding path, and fourth primary winding path.

16. The apparatus as in claim 1, wherein the layer of magnetically permeable material is a first substrate, the apparatus further comprising: a second substrate, the first substrate affixed to the second substrate; and switch circuitry disposed on the second substrate, the switch circuitry operative to control first current through the first primary winding path and second current through the second primary winding path.

17. The apparatus as in claim 16 further comprising: a third substrate, the first substrate affixed to the third substrate; and a dynamic load powered by the first current and the second current, the third substrate disposed between the first substrate and the dynamic load.

18. The apparatus as in claim 1 further comprising: a first substrate, wherein the layer of magnetically permeable material is embedded within the first substrate; and switch circuitry operative to control first current through the first primary winding path and second current through the second primary winding path.

19. The apparatus as in claim 18 further comprising: a circuit component powered by the first current and the second current; and a second substrate, the first substrate affixed to the second substrate, the first substrate disposed between the second substrate and the circuit component.

20. A method comprising: receiving magnetically permeable material; fabricating a first winding pair to include a first primary winding path and a first secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable material; fabricating a second winding pair to include a second primary winding path and a second secondary winding path extending through the magnetically permeable

material; and via a first electrically conductive path, coupling the first secondary winding path in series with the second secondary winding path.
